

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 6 5 3
♥ 10 9 5 2
♦ A 8 5
♣ 10 9

♠ A K

♥ A J

♦ Q J 10 2

♣ A Q J 7 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 8 4

♥ 4

♦ 7 6 3

♣ K 6 4 3

♠ 7 2

♥ K Q 8 7 6 3

♦ K 9 4

♣ 8 5

West	North	East	South
			2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by North			

You were probably stunned when you picked up this hand and even more stunned when partner bid.

Your biggest problem is that partner has opened with a weak bid and won't credit you with such a huge hand. So you must make sure you don't make a bid he might pass until you're ready.

For example, suppose you made a jump shift to 4♣. Would partner know what that meant? Do you know what it meant?

The best(?) bid at this point is probably 2NT. Everybody knows what that means. Partner is forced to reply, and will either rebid his suit with a minimum hand or show a "feature" if his hand is better than minimum.

Partner replies 3♦.

Trust your partner. He has shown a better-than-minimum Weak-2 bid, probably 9-11 points, and a high card in ♦s, either the ♦A or ♦K.

With your hand you don't need anything else to make a slam. You have to decide between 6♥ and 6NT. Based on your reluctance to have an opening ♣ lead go through your ♣ A Q you choose 6NT.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠Q.

North plays 6NT. East leads the ♠Q.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 6? : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 9

The winner list isn't as bad as it looks, once you drive out the ♦A you'll have your three extra winners in ♦s.

In fact, your only real problem is making sure you get all 6 ♥ winners. If the ♥s split 3-2 it's easy, but if they are 4-1 you cannot afford to overtake the ♥J at the second trick. Fortunately dummy has both the ♦K and the ♦9.

Win the ♠A. Play ♥A and ♥J. East shows out on the second one. Lead your ♦2 to dummy's ♦9. Either you are in dummy now to run the ♥s, or West wins the trick with the ♦A. In this case you can win his return (don't finesse if he leads a ♣), and get to dummy with the ♦K to run the ♥s.

A 4-1 split isn't as likely as a 3-2 split.

But when you can

In this case dummy had a certain entry in the ♦ suit so you take advantage of that entry.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 3
 ♥ 5 4 3 2
 ♦ Q 4
 ♣ A K 10 8 3

♠ K 10 9 8 5 2

♥ 9 7

♦ 10 2

♣ Q J 4



♠ A J 4
 ♥ K Q J 10 8 6
 ♦ 8 7 3
 ♣ 6

♠ Q 6

♥ A

♦ A K J 9 6 5

♣ 9 7 5 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

2♠

1♥

2♦

3♥

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3♥ by East

With 11 points you would probably have bid 3♥, a limit raise, if North hadn't overcalled.

But you now doubt your ♦Q is worth 2 points so you just say 2♥.

Now South comes in with 2♠ and it is passed around to you.

With a known 9-card fit this hand is worth a 3♥ bid.

Everybody passes.

West would play 3♥.

Click

East plays 3♥. South leads ♦A, ♦K, ♦J. North plays first the ♦10, then ♦2.

East plays 3♥. South leads ♦A, ♦K, ♦J. North plays first the ♦10, then ♦2.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 0 : Total = 6

Although there are two ♠ losers in your hand, one can either be ruffed in dummy or discarded on a high ♣. So you really only have one loser too many.

You should realize that if you ruff this ♦ with one of dummy's teensy ♥s it will be over-ruffed. North did signal a doubleton. The loss of the teensy ♥ doesn't worry you, you have plenty of them. But the loss of the opportunity to dump a loser should worry you a lot.

So don't ruff at all. Discard a ♠. Now you can ruff your other ♠ loser in dummy.

Be ever watchful for situations where you may be over-ruffed.

Often, like in this deal, you can discard a loser instead.

Board 5
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ K J 7 3
 ♥ Q 7 6 2
 ♦ 10 9 3
 ♣ 9 5

♠ 9 2
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ K 6 5 2
 ♣ A J 10 3 2



♠ 10 8 6 5
 ♥ K 9 4 3
 ♦ 7 4
 ♣ 8 7 4

♠ A Q 4
 ♥ A J 10
 ♦ A Q J 8
 ♣ K Q 6

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5NT
Pass	6 ♦	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♦ 10.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♦ 10.

Winner count: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 5 : Total = 11

You need just one more winner. If the ♠K is with East then a simple finesse will provide it. This would not be a terrible plan - you can expect it to succeed 50% of the time. Of course that means you will go down the other 50% of the time.

The double finesse in ♥s is better. If East holds **EITHER** the ♥K **OR** the ♥Q you will succeed. This raises your chances to 75%.

So win the opening lead with dummy's ♦ K. Play the ♥5, finessing your ♥10. West will probably win this with either ♥K or ♥Q. No matter. Win West's probable ♦ return and take 5 ♣ tricks, discarding your 2 ♠ losers. Lead dummy's ♥7 and finesse the ♥J. When this wins the rest of the tricks are yours.

Sometimes you will have two or three possible ways to try for a contract. You need to evaluate them as to which is the most likely to succeed. There are times when this can be very difficult to analyze, but fortunately some choices are pretty easy to make.

The choice between a single finesse and a double finesse is one that you will face many times. So remember that the double finesse works 75% of the time.

With 9 points you have enough strength to make a positive response. And with a good 5-card suit you respond 3 ♣.

Partner says 4NT.

Partner's 4NT bid is clearly Blackwood. With one Ace you answer 5 ♦.

Partner says 5NT.

Partner's 5NT bid guarantees that your side has all the Aces, and asks for your Kings. With one King you answer 6 ♦.

Partner says 6NT and you pass.

North would play 6NT.

Click